9.4 External Fixator

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I do not like how my leg looks with the frame." **Objective** • External fixator on the tibia • Will not look at his leg	**ACTUAL** **Disturbed body image** related to external fixator as evidenced by avoiding looking at the leg.	Looks at the leg and helps with pin care.	• Explain what the frame is for and roughly how long it will stay on. • Encourage him to help with his care. • Suggest loose clothes to cover the frame.	Helps with his care: **goal met**.
Subjective • "How do I clean the pins at home?" **Objective** • Going home with the frame on Cannot explain how to care for the pins	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to pin-site care as evidenced by questions.	Shows you how he cleans the pin sites.	• Teach pin-site cleaning according to the protocol. • Teach the signs of infection. • Tell him never to adjust the clamps himself.	Shows you correctly: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Several pins • Serous ooze at two sites	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: pins through skin and bone.	Pin sites stay free of infection.	• Look at the pins every day. • Pin-site care according to the protocol. • Watch his temperature.	No infection: **goal met**.